

TABLE 8.3 : LITERACY RATES BY SEX AND AGE-1971 CENSUS

Age	Literacy rates per 1000			Ratio of male rate to female rate (percentage)
	Total	Male	Female	
10 & Over	785	856	709	120.7
10-14	830	837	823	101.7
15-19	867	883	851	103.8
20-24	871	910	831	109.5
25-29	847	910	783	116.2
30-34	824	904	738	122.5
35-39	745	863	625	138.1
40-44	749	867	613	141.4
45-49	701	840	544	154.4
50-54	687	833	513	162.4
55-59	639	791	453	174.6
60-64	605	756	410	184.4
65-69	573	735	375	196.0
70-74	532	699	318	219.8
75 & Over	429	608	238	255.5

In addition to giving a clear picture of the current situation, the table also provides an insight into the historical development with regard to literacy. The lower rates at older ages and greater disparity between the rates for males and females at the higher ages reflect the poor educational facilities as well as the greater neglect of female education in the past decades. The near equality of the rates for the very young ages indicates that educational opportunities at present are more nearly equal for the two sexes than in earlier times. It could therefore be expected that in due course as the present younger generation becomes older the existing disparity between the sexes will be considerably narrowed.

8.5 Urban-rural differentials in literacy

Table 8.4 shows the literacy rates for urban and rural sectors of the population. Between 1963 and 1971, there has been an improvement in the literacy levels in the country as a whole and in the rural areas. In the urban areas, however, the number of literates per 1000 persons aged 10 years and over has recorded a slight decline from 876 in 1963 to 862 in 1971. This is probably due to the fact that some of the new areas classified as urban in 1971 Census were included in the rural sector in 1963. The comparatively lower literacy rates of these new urban areas have had the effect of reducing the literacy rate of the urban area as a whole in 1971.

→ between the male and female rates. Among the younger age groups the differences between the literacy rates of the males and females are smaller than in the older age groups. At ages 65 and over the male literacy rates are almost twice that of the females.